colonial stamp. The influence of both secularised and non-secularised Protestant Reformation-informed Christian OET is inescapable. Therefore, if at all we wish to judge Bharat's contemporary social structures or their past, a decolonial approach would require that they be understood *minus* the judgement and sanctimony induced by Reformed and Enlightened European coloniality. By 'understood', I do not mean glorified, I simply mean made sense of for what they were before the coloniser's evangelising and civilising influence afflicted them and their characterisation.

I am supported in these views by the stellar work of several scholars, such as Dr. S.N. Balagangadhara, Dr. Jakob De Roover and Nicholas B. Dirks. This is not a call to authority, instead it is my position that the work of these scholars is consistent with the central theme of the decolonial school, that is, the existence of coloniality is a fact. The corollary being that any work that fails to or deliberately ignores the impact of coloniality on Indic societal structures and dynamics perpetuates coloniality. To explain this position in greater detail, as in the first section, I will use this opportunity to discuss material that, in my opinion, deserves wider dissemination and whose relevance alongside, if not within, the framework of decoloniality is evident to me.

In this regard, the works of Dr. Balagangadhara and Dr. De Roover are particularly important since they are closer to the decolonial school owing to their recognition of the existence of 'colonial consciousness', which is similar to Quijano's recognition of coloniality.[1] Based on what I have read thus far, I was, in fact, surprised at the lack of a direct and express handshake between the scholarship on decoloniality, which focusses predominantly on the Americas, and the scholarship on colonial consciousness, whose primary focus is Bharat. Therefore, before I proceed to examine the literature on the impact of coloniality on religion, caste, tribe and political thought in the context of Bharat, it is important to understand the nature of 'colonial consciousness' as formulated by Balagangadhara and De Roover, with particular attention to Bharat.

Colonial Consciousness, Postcolonialism and the Native's Options

Balagandhara and De Roover highlight that apart from being malleable and fluid over time labels, such as 'the Left' and 'the Right', 'liberal' and 'conservative', are located within the same worldview, namely the colonial